

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Chevening Scholar and MSc candidate in Social Research Methods at LSE, with two years managing field operations for a randomized controlled trial on women's collective action, MGNREGA access, and local governance across 125 village councils in rural Bihar, plus over six years in development research and program delivery. Skilled in survey design, SurveyCTO programming, enumerator training, high-frequency data-quality monitoring, and reproducible data management and analysis in Stata & R. Comfortable running fieldwork independently with a remotely based research team.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Research Associate

Sept 2023 – Aug 2025

with *Dr. Niharika Singh (LSE)* and *Dr. MR Sharan (University of Maryland)*

Bihar, India

- Led all project coordination for a randomized trial across 125 village councils, managing timelines, deliverables, budgets, and research activities in a two-PI, two RAs and 30 enumerators team
- Designed and managed phone and field-based surveys covering 6,250+ rural households; programmed instruments on SurveyCTO, training enumerators, and running high-frequency data quality checks to monitor fieldwork
- Conducted exploratory qualitative research and field pilots of instruments across survey rounds to refine the language and field protocols; revised and translated questionnaires in colloquial Hindi
- Cleaned, harmonized and analyzed large-scale household survey and administrative data; produced descriptive statistics and performed econometric analyses - balance checks, ITT estimates, heterogeneity of treatment effect
- Acted as primary liaison between PIs, survey firm, and field staff - resolving implementation issues in real time; led administrative tasks: budget management, ethical approvals, recruited and managed interns and freelancers
- Conducted literature reviews on women's labour force participation, collective action, local governance and social protection; drafted 10+ research proposals securing approximately \$85,000 in funding

Research Intern

Jun 2022 – Jul 2022

J-PAL South Asia

Bhubaneswar, India

- Supported field preparation for a randomised evaluation of high-frequency monitoring in Odisha's Public Distribution System; drafted survey protocols and enumerator training materials, and conducted qualitative stakeholder interviews to inform key concepts in instrument design

Research and Program Consultant

Sept 2019 – Mar 2021

VSTF, Department of Rural Development, Government of Maharashtra

Mumbai, India

- Built and managed an M&E system that covered 1,000+ villages, oversaw the entire data pipeline and monitored performance across 16 themes and 70+ indicators in real time
- Led a livelihoods project supporting women-led enterprises in a tribal district, translating a field scoping study into proposals that secured approximately \$160,000 in corporate social responsibility funding and aligned with state and central government schemes
- Designed results frameworks for rural development programs, defining outcome and output indicators, baselines and targets, data sources and reporting frequency. Disaggregated indicators by gender and social group and strengthened performance reporting to state government and corporate funders
- Supervised a team of 25 grassroots fellows across 450+ village councils, coordinating between field staff, district administration, and state departments to strengthen rural service delivery

Project Executive

Dec 2015 – Mar 2019

NIRMAN, SEARCH

Gadchiroli, India

- Ran survey-based program evaluations to assess effectiveness and refine curriculum and mentoring design, within a youth leadership program in Gadchiroli, one of India's most underserved districts

Research Intern

Dec 2014 – Nov 2015

Nimbkar Agricultural Research Institute

Phaltan, India

SKILLS

Technical: Stata (advanced), SurveyCTO (advanced), KoboToolBox, R, Python, GitHub, L^AT_EX, Qualtrics, Excel

Research: Survey Methodology, Causal Inference, Econometric Analysis, Literature Review, Data Management

Language skills: English (fluent), Marathi (native), Hindi (native)

EDUCATION

London School of Economics and Political Science

London, UK

MSc Social Research Methods (Chevening Scholar 2025-26)

Sept 2025 - Sept 2026

Relevant Coursework: Causal Inference for Observational and Experimental Studies, Survey Methodology, Applied Regression Analysis, Computational Text Analysis and LLMs, and Qualitative Research Methods

South Asian University

New Delhi, India

M.A. Development Economics (SAU Merit Scholar 2021-23)

Sept 2021 - May 2023

Relevant Coursework: Development Economics, Econometric Methods, Statistics, Environmental Economics

MITx MicroMasters Program in Data, Economics, and Development Policy

Data Analysis for Social Scientists

2022

The Challenges of Global Poverty

2022

Microeconomics

2022

Maharashtra Institute of Technology

Pune, India

B.E. Mechanical Engineering

Jun 2010 - May 2014

RESEARCH & WRITING

Descriptive Representation, Substantive Exclusion

Bihar, India

MSc Dissertation, London School of Economics and Political Science

Sept 2025 - Aug 2026

Telephonic survey of 299 elected village heads across Bihar with two embedded experiments and qualitative interviews. Awarded a £400 departmental research grant in a competitive round capped at £500 per student.

Procedural Representation and Elite Backlash: Experiences of everyday discrimination faced by SC village presidents in India

Bihar, India

Graduate Inequality Review, University of Oxford

Aug 2026

Thematic analysis of interviews with serving Scheduled Caste village heads, examining bureaucratic obstruction, social micro-aggression, and pressure to act as a proxy for dominant-caste elites.

Effect of Social Audits on the MGNREGA Program Delivery and Leakages

New Delhi, India

Master's Dissertation, South Asian University

Jun 2022 - May 2023

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

UNICEF India

India

Member, Evaluation Reference Group

Jul 2026 – present

- Member of the reference group for the evaluation of a migration support program, reviewing the inception report, evaluation design and methodology

EvalYouth Asia

Asia Pacific Region

Co-leader

May 2022 – Jul 2025

- Led EvalYouth Asia, a regional chapter of the EvalYouth Global Network to create a network of Young and Emerging Evaluators (YEEs) from the Asia Pacific region
- Organized two in-person M&E capacity-building workshops in Manila (2023) and Colombo (2024), securing \$30,000 in funding from UNFPA and training 70+ emerging evaluators from across the Asia-Pacific region

ACHIEVEMENTS

Chevening Scholarship

London, UK

UK Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office

Sept 2025 - Aug 2026

Fully funded scholarship awarded by the UK FCDO to emerging leaders from over 160 countries

SAU Merit Scholarship

New Delhi, India

South Asian University

Sept 2021 - May 2023

Fully funded merit scholarship awarded on academic performance across the MA Development Economics cohort